5.3.2 First Column: Intervention Logic

If-then causality

The first column of the Logframe matrix summarises the 'means-end' logic of the proposed project (also known as the 'intervention logic').

When the objective hierarchy is read from the bottom up, it can be expressed in terms of:

IF adequate inputs/resources are provided, **THEN** activities can be undertaken;
IF the activities are undertaken, **THEN** results can be produced;
IF results are produced, **THEN** the purpose will be achieved; and
IF the purpose is achieved, **THEN** this should contribute towards the overall objective

If reversed, we can say that:

IF we wish to contribute to the overall objective, **THEN** we must achieve the purpose
IF we wish to achieve the purpose, **THEN** we must deliver the specified results
IF we wish to deliver the results, **THEN** the specified activities must be implemented; and
IF we wish to implement the specified activities, **THEN** we must apply identified inputs/resources.

This logic is tested and refined by the analysis of assumptions in the fourth column of the matrix (described below in section 5.3.3).

Management influence

The Logframe helps to indicate the degree of control managers have over the different levels of the project's objectives. Managers should have significant direct control over inputs, activities and the delivery of results, and should be held appropriately accountable for effectively managing theses elements of the project.

However managers can only exert influence over the achievement of the project purpose through the way in which the delivery of results is managed. Project managers generally have no direct influence over the contribution the project makes to the overall objective, and can only be expected to monitor the broader policy and programme environment to help ensure the project continues to be contextually relevant.